SpeedUP

English Course

Talking About the Future

predict
prever, predizer

Scientists **predict** temperatures will rise.

probably
provavelemente

She will **probably** arrive late.

possibly
possivelmente

It will **possibly** rain tomorrow.

likely
provável

It is likely that prices will increase.

unlikely
improvável

It is **unlikely** that school will be cancelled.

chance
chance, probabilidade

There is a good **chance** of snow tonight.

forecast
(tempo/mercado)

The weather **forecast** says it will be sunny.

expect
esperar, prever

I **expect** things to get better soon.

anticipate
antecipar

We **anticipate** a busy weekend.

What We Believe Will Happen

What We Believe Will Happen

Use will when you are confident about a future event — based on knowledge, logic, or belief.

Structure: Subject + will + base verb

Example	Meaning
*The population **will** grow significantly.*	previsão baseada em dados
*I think he **will** get the job.*	previsão baseada em opinião
*Technology **will** change everything.*	afirmação com confiança
*It **will** be cold tomorrow.*	previsão geral
She won't come to the party.	previsão negativa

When You're Not 100% Sure

Use might, may, and could to show that something is possible — but not certain.

Structure: Subject + might / may / could + base verb

- Negative forms: - *It might not work.* → talvez não funcione - *She may not come.* → talvez ela não venha - *He couldn't be right.* → ele não pode estar certo (diferente de "could not = impossibility")

💡 May and might are interchangeable in most everyday situations.
Could often implies something hypothetical or open to speculation.

Modal	Level of certainty	Example
may	~50% — possibilidade real	*It may rain this afternoon.*
might	~40% — menos certo	*I might go to the gym later.*
could	possibilidade aberta / hipotética	*That could be the answer.*

How Sure Are You? Express It with Words

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Probability adverbs tell your listener *how likely* something is.
They usually come before the main verb or after the verb "to be".

definitely	~100% —	*We will definitely need more time.*
certainly	~95% — com certeza	*This will certainly be a challenge.*
probably	~75% — provavelmente	*She will probably pass the exam.*
perhaps / maybe	~50% — talvez	*Perhaps the meeting will be rescheduled.*
possibly	~30% — possivelmente	*It could possibly work out.*
unlikely	~10% — improvável	*It's unlikely that prices will drop.*

It is likely / unlikely / possible / probable that...

"It is likely / unlikely / possible / probable that..."

These structures are common in formal and written English — and very useful for making clear predictions.

Structure	Example
It is likely that...	*It is likely that the price will increase next year.*
It is unlikely that...	*It is unlikely that they will cancel the event.*
It is possible that...	*It is possible that she will change her mind.*
It is probable that...	*It is probable that the team will win.*
There is a chance that...	*There is a chance that flights will be delayed.*
There is no chance that...	*There is no chance that the project finishes today.*